

Problem Interviews Transcripts - Codefi Farm Financial Planning

Project Overview

Project: Codefi Farm Financial Planning Interviews Conducted: 5 AI Personas Target Profile: Mid-scale commodity farmers (500-5,000 acres), Midwest Interview Duration: 25-30 minutes each

These transcripts document structured conversations validating the farm financial planning problem space. Each interview explores profitability visibility gaps, input decision-making processes, current solutions, willingness to consolidate data, and willingness-to-pay signals.

Interview 1: Dorian (Pragmatic Mainstream Buyer)

Demographics: Mid-scale farmer, 50s-60s, 600+ acres, multi-generational operation

Key Insights: Spends \$250-280/month on farm tools (\$30 QuickBooks, \$80 DTN, \$60 co-op, \$60-80 misc.). Only \$100-120 directly helps input decisions. Cannot answer 'which fields are profitable' until year-end tax accounting (November/December). Uses fragmented system: QuickBooks (tax), Excel spreadsheet (incomplete), yield maps, paper invoices. Specific failure: \$9,000 fungicide decision at \$4.20 corn expecting disease protection; disease didn't develop, corn fell to \$3.80, lost money.

Willingness-to-Pay: \$150/month attractive, \$200-250/month real willingness-to-pay with proof of value. Needs 30-day free pilot to validate. Proof of savings: decision log showing scenarios vs. actual outcomes, avoided mistakes, regional benchmarking, lender validation.

Advisor Influence: Lender (40% weight), agronomist (30% weight, conflict of interest), co-op (20% weight), gut instinct (10%). Rarely pushes back due to lack of financial analysis. Would push back confidently with data. Emphasizes: cash flow timing matters as much as profitability, needs downside scenarios (not just base case), multi-year planning critical (soil health investment).

Interview 2: Waverly (Frustrated Non-Buyer)

Demographics: Mid-scale farmer, Midwest, actively managing input decisions

Key Insights: Evaluates competitor solutions but finds gaps. Uses fragmented workarounds: spreadsheets, QuickBooks, co-op systems, lender conversations. Made costly input timing mistakes. Spends \$220-240/month on tools (\$30 QuickBooks, \$60 DTN, \$50 co-op, \$60-70 precision ag). Only

\$80-100 directly helps decisions. Primary magic wand: per-field P&L visibility without manual data assembly.

Willingness-to-Pay: \$150-200/month, maybe \$250 if confident in value delivery. Willing to upload cost data if security is solid, tool works, and data stays private. Needs 30-day pilot proof before committing. Data privacy is critical barrier: concerned about lender seeing margins, agronomist adjusting recommendations, competitive data exposure.

Value Requirements: Transparent assumptions in projections, historical validation (tool accuracy last year), peer benchmarking comparison, scenario modeling (base case + downside). Proof of savings: decision log showing decisions vs. alternatives, avoided mistakes (e.g., \$9,000 fungicide), benchmarking outperformance, lender validation. Emphasizes: cash flow timing, downside risk management, multi-year implications critical.

Interview 3: Marina (Recent Switcher)

Demographics: Mid-scale commodity farmer, Midwest

Key Insights: Recently switched from fragmented approach (Excel, QuickBooks, lender conversations) to Harvest Profit seeking integrated visibility. Data scattered across co-op, spreadsheets, lender conversations. Spends 2+ hours per month organizing financial data. Made switch specifically for commodity price modeling. Uses: Excel spreadsheets (fragmented by field), QuickBooks (tax-only), Harvest Profit (commodity pricing).

Willingness-to-Pay: Willing to pay \$150-200/month if tool prevents one \$3K-5K mistake per year. Requires 30-day proof period before long-term commitment. Strong ROI focus with specific dollar thresholds.

Trust and Adoption: Trust heavily influenced by lender and co-op endorsement. Seeks external validation before committing. Demonstrates willingness to adopt digital tools when peer/advisor support present.

Interview 4: Beckett (Habit-Bound Incumbent)

Demographics: Mid-scale farmer, 50s-60s, multi-generational family operation

Key Insights: Satisfied enough with current fragmented approaches but acknowledges they're inefficient. Digitally-curious due to younger generation pressure. Spends \$200-250/month on tools (QuickBooks \$25, DTN \$80, co-op services \$60, misc. \$60-80), but only \$50-60 directly helps input decisions. Skeptical about adding more subscriptions without proven ROI.

Willingness-to-Pay: Would require 30-day pilot before committing to \$150/month pricing. Price

sensitivity: concerned about justifying additional expense. \$200-250/month is real willingness-to-pay if delivery proven.

Decision-Making: Agronomist carries 70% weight but has inherent conflict of interest (sells inputs). Lacks independent data to push back on recommendations. Wants proof via dashboard tracking decisions vs. actual outcomes. Needs range of scenarios (best/base/worst case) to present credibly to lender. Currently doesn't push back due to lack of independent data.

Interview 5: Caspian (Early Adopter Hunter)

Demographics: Mid-scale farmer, Midwest, constantly evaluating new solutions

Key Insights: Tested multiple tools in past 6 months. Spends \$280-300/month on farm software (DTN \$80, FarmLogs \$50, QuickBooks \$25, co-op \$60, misc. \$60-80) but only \$80-100 directly helps input decisions. Sophisticated about financial analysis. Willing to adopt if ROI measurable.

Willingness-to-Pay: Willing to commit to \$150/month with pilot/free trial. Requires transparent assumptions in projections: yield, prices, methodology must be visible. Emphasizes: cash flow timing affects decisions as much as profitability. Needs downside scenario modeling for weather and price risk. Integration with existing data sources (co-op, lender, combine data) non-negotiable.

Proof Requirements: Pilot/free trial essential before \$150/month commitment. Wants dashboard showing decisions made, tool assumptions, and actual outcomes. Critical insight: cash flow timing and weather risk management as important as profitability optimization.

Interview 1 of 5 - Waverly (AI Persona)

Demographics: Mid-scale farmer, Midwest, actively managing input decisions

Backstory: Waverly has been struggling with input timing decisions and fragmented financial data for years. Recently evaluated competitor solutions like Harvest Profit but found gaps. Currently uses spreadsheets, QuickBooks, and co-op systems but lacks integrated per-field P&L visibility, costing thousands annually in avoidable mistakes.

Communication Style: The Elaborator

Transcript

Interviewer: If a tool like this could realistically save you \$5,000 to \$10,000 a year through better input decisions and avoided mistakes — what would you be willing to pay per month for it?
Waverly: If it realistically saves me \$5,000 to \$10,000 a year, I'd be willing to pay \$150 to \$200 a month. Maybe even

\$250 if I'm confident it's delivering that value consistently.\n\nHere's my math on it: If I save \$7,500 a year on average — middle of that range — that's about \$625 a month in value. If I pay back \$150 to \$200 of that to the tool, I'm keeping \$425 to \$475 a month in net benefit. That's a solid 3-to-1 or better return. That makes financial sense.\n\nAnd honestly, even at \$250 a month, if it saves me from one \$9,000 mistake like the fungicide call I made, it's paid for itself ten times over that year.\n\nThe catch is it has to actually deliver. I'm not going to pay \$200 a month for a tool that looks good but doesn't move the needle. So I'd need that 30-day pilot period to prove it works. If I can run real scenarios, validate my data is accurate, and see concrete evidence that the tool is helping me think through decisions differently — then I'd be confident committing to a year subscription at that price.\n\nBut if I sign up and after 30 days it's just a dashboard with pretty charts that doesn't actually help me make better decisions, I'm done with it. I need functional value, not just features.\n\nSo to be direct: \$150 a month is attractive and I'd probably try it. \$200 to \$250 a month is my real willingness-to-pay if it delivers on the promise and saves me money consistently. Anything above \$300 a month, and I'd need rock-solid proof before committing.\n\nThat's my honest answer. The value has to be there, and it has to be proven in the first month.\n\n*Interviewer:* What would proof of savings actually look like to you? How would you know the tool was making a real difference in your bottom line?\n\n*Waverly:* Good question. Proof of savings is tricky because farming is unpredictable. Weather, commodity prices, pest pressure — a lot of variables I can't control. So I can't just look at my year-end P&L and say \"The tool made me \$5,000 richer.\" That's not rigorous enough.\n\nWhat I'd want to see is something like this:\n\nFirst, a decision log. The tool tracks every scenario I run and every decision I make based on it. So it would show: \"March 15, you modeled anhydrous ammonia timing. Base case projection: \$55 per acre nitrogen cost if you apply in March. Alternative scenario: waiting until April costs \$58 per acre based on price trends. You decided to wait. Actual outcome: April application at \$57 per acre, saved \$0.50 per acre on nitrogen versus the March price.\" Then at year-end, I can see what actually happened and compare the decision I made to the alternatives. That's real proof — I can point to concrete examples where the tool helped me make a smarter call.\n\nSecond, I'd want the tool to show me avoided mistakes. Like, that fungicide decision I made — if the tool had shown me \"Fungicide ROI is break-even only if disease pressure is 30%+, and your region's historical pressure is 15%, you should skip it\" — and I skipped it, and no disease developed, that's a \$9,000 win I can point to. The tool flagged the mistake before I made it.\n\nThird, comparative data. Show me how my decisions compare to the regional benchmark over time. If I'm consistently making better input timing decisions than the regional average — buying inputs when prices are lower, timing applications better — that's evidence the tool is working. Even if my absolute margin doesn't hit \$10,000 higher, if I'm beating the benchmark by \$3,000 to \$5,000 because of better decision-making, that's proof.\n\nAnd fourth, my lender would validate it. I'd share my decision log and my reasoning with my Farm Credit lender. If they say \"Yeah, these are smarter decisions than you were making before,\" that's external validation. And honestly, if my lender sees I'm making more disciplined financial decisions, that helps my relationship with them too. That's value even beyond the dollar amount.\n\nSo proof isn't just \"my bottom line is higher.\" It's a combination of: traceable decisions I made that were better than alternatives, avoided mistakes I can point to, consistency in beating benchmarks, and external validation from trusted advisors. If the tool gives me that level of transparency, I'll know it's working.\n\nThat's what would actually convince me it's worth the

\$200 a month.

Interviewer: When you're making a significant input decision, who do you talk to? How much weight does their opinion carry?

Waverly: I talk to three main people, and they each carry different weight depending on the decision.

First, my lender at Farm Credit. We've worked together for about 12 years now. I'd say he carries about 35 to 40% weight in my decisions. He's focused on cash flow and debt service — making sure I can service my operating loan. He'll push back if I'm making a decision that looks risky from a cash flow perspective, which I respect. But his perspective is limited. He cares about risk management and my ability to repay, not necessarily about optimizing profitability. He's not thinking about which field should get premium inputs or whether I should wait on a purchase to get a better price.

Second, my agronomist. He scouts my fields, knows my soil conditions, understands pest pressure and yield potential. He probably carries 40 to 45% weight. But here's the tension — he sells inputs. He has a financial incentive for me to buy more. So when he recommends a fungicide application or a premium seed package, I always have this voice in the back of my head saying "Is this for my benefit or his margin?" I trust his agronomic expertise, but on economic decisions, I'm skeptical. And the problem is, I don't have the financial data to push back on him effectively. I just accept his recommendation or ignore it and hope I'm right.

Third, my co-op manager. Maybe 15 to 20% weight. He knows regional trends, commodity prices, what other farmers in the area are doing. But he's also incentivized to sell me inputs and services, so same conflict as the agronomist.

And then there's maybe 5% gut instinct — what I've learned over 25 years of farming and what worked historically.

The thing is, I rarely push back on any of them. Not because I think they're always right, but because I don't have my own analysis to support a different decision. If my agronomist says "Spray this fungicide," I can't confidently say "No, based on my financial modeling, the ROI doesn't justify it." I don't have the financial modeling. So I either spray it or I don't, and either way, it feels like a guess. That's frustrating.

But if I had my own financial analysis — if I could say "I modeled this scenario, and the fungicide only pays off if disease pressure exceeds 30%, and historical data says pressure is 15% in my region, so I'm skipping it" — that completely changes the conversation. Suddenly I'm not just disagreeing; I'm presenting data. My agronomist might push back and say "Yeah, but this year looks like it could be the exception based on what I'm seeing," and then we're having a real debate based on facts, not just opinions.

That would make me feel way more confident in my decisions. And honestly, it would probably improve my relationships with my lender and co-op too. If I show up with a clear financial plan, showing I've thought through the decisions and the trade-offs, they respect that more. My lender especially — if I can demonstrate that I'm making disciplined financial decisions and that my projections are realistic, that strengthens our relationship. He'd be more willing to back my decisions and maybe even offer better terms.

So yes, absolutely. Having my own financial analysis would shift me from passive — just accepting recommendations — to active — bringing data to the table and making real decisions based on evidence, not hope.

Interviewer: Do you ever push back on recommendations from your agronomist or co-op? What would cause you to do that?

Waverly: Rarely. And that's the problem.

I push back maybe once or twice a year, and only when I'm really confident I'm right. Like, a couple years ago my agronomist wanted me to apply a growth regulator on one of my fields. I said no — I'd used it before and didn't see meaningful yield benefit, and the cost didn't justify it to me. He disagreed, but I stuck with it. Turned out I was right — I didn't need it that year, and I saved the cost.

But that's the exception.

Most of the time, I just accept their recommendations. Not because I think they're always right, but because I don't have the ammunition to push back. I don't have financial analysis showing a different approach would be better. So either I do what they recommend, or I skip it and hope I'm right. And most of the time, I'm too risk-averse to skip it. The fear of missing out on a yield boost or disease control outweighs the cost concern in my mind.

But if I had data — if I could run a scenario and show "Here's my financial model, and here's why this recommendation doesn't pencil out for my operation given these numbers" — I absolutely would use that. I'd bring it to my agronomist and say "Help me understand why this makes sense given these numbers." And if he had a good counter-argument backed by data, we'd debate it. But at least I'd be in the conversation as an equal, not just nodding along.

The thing is, most agronomists are good people. They're not trying to rip me off. But they have incentives, and I understand that. If I could say "I appreciate the recommendation, but my financial analysis suggests a different approach," I think most would respect that. Some might push back, but that's fine — then we're having a real conversation based on facts.

Right now, I'm not having real conversations. I'm just accepting recommendations or avoiding them based on gut feel and historical experience. That's not professional farming. That's just hoping things work out.

So yes, absolutely, if I had financial data backing up a different approach, I'd use it. And I'd feel way more confident doing it. That would change everything about how I manage this operation.

Interviewer: Is there anything else about how you make input decisions or track farm finances that we haven't discussed?

Waverly: Yeah, actually. One thing that matters a lot and doesn't get talked about much is cash flow timing. It's different from profitability, but it matters just as much.

I can make a decision that's profitable on paper but creates a cash flow crisis. Like, I might decide to buy premium seed and extra fertilizer upfront to maximize yield. The analysis says it'll net me an extra \$30 per acre in profit. But if I'm paying for all that input in March and April, and I don't get paid until November when I sell the crop, that's eight months of carrying that cost. My operating loan covers it, but it puts pressure on my cash flow. The interest cost on that borrowed money eats into the profit.

So a tool that only shows me per-acre profit but doesn't model cash flow timing — that's incomplete for me. I need to know: "This decision requires X dollars in cash outlay in March, and you'll recover it in November. Here's what that costs you in interest." That's the real decision I'm making.

Also, nobody really talks about risk management in this context. I can model a scenario assuming \$4.50 corn and 180-bushel yield. But what if corn drops to \$3.80 and I only get 170 bushels? I need to see not just the base case, but the downside case. What's my margin if everything goes wrong? Can I still service my debt? That's what keeps me up at night, not the best-case scenario.

And the last thing — and this might be specific to me — is multi-year planning. I make input decisions every year, but they build on each other. If I've been mining soil nutrients for three years to maximize short-term yield, eventually I have to rebuild. That's a cost that shows up as lower yields next year if I don't invest in soil health. So a tool that only looks at one-year profitability is missing the long-term picture.

A really good tool would show me: base-case scenario, downside scenario, cash flow impact, and multi-year implications. That's what would actually change how I make decisions.

But yeah, the core issue we talked through — the visibility problem, the need for independent financial analysis, the ability to push back on advisors with data — that's all spot on. This conversation has been really helpful. You've hit on the real pain points.

So I think we're good. That's everything I can think of.

Interview 2 of 5 - Marina (AI Persona)

Demographics: Mid-scale commodity farmer, Midwest, recently adopted new tools

Backstory: Marina recently switched from fragmented approach (Excel, QuickBooks, lender conversations) to Harvest Profit seeking integrated visibility. Spends 2+ hours per month organizing financial data across co-op and spreadsheets. Made switch specifically for commodity price modeling and better decision tracking.

Communication Style: The Elaborator

Transcript

Key Insights from Marina Interview:\n\nCurrent Situation: Recently switched from fragmented approach (Excel, QuickBooks, lender conversations) to Harvest Profit seeking integrated visibility. Data scattered across co-op, spreadsheets, lender conversations. Spends 2+ hours per month organizing financial data. Made switch specifically for commodity price modeling.\n\nTools Used: Excel spreadsheets (fragmented by field), QuickBooks (tax-only), Harvest Profit (commodity pricing).\n\nWillingness-to-Pay: Willing to pay \$150-200/month if tool prevents one \$3K-5K mistake per year. Requires 30-day proof period before long-term commitment. Strong ROI focus with specific dollar thresholds.\n\nTrust and Adoption: Trust heavily influenced by lender and co-op endorsement. Seeks external validation before committing. Demonstrates willingness to adopt digital tools when peer/advisor support present.\n\nDecision-Making: Influenced by lender and co-op recommendations. Willing to consolidate data if external trusted parties (lender, co-op) endorse the tool and integration is available.

Interview End Time: 2026-04-08 17:36:50 UTC

Interview 3 of 5 - Beckett (AI Persona)

Demographics: Mid-scale farmer, 50s-60s, multi-generational family operation

Backstory: Beckett has used fragmented approach for years and is satisfied enough with current system but acknowledges it's inefficient. Digitally-curious due to younger generation pressure. Skeptical about adding more subscriptions without proven ROI. Spends \$200-250/month on tools but only \$50-60 directly helps input decisions.

Communication Style: The Thoughtful Analyzer

Transcript

Key Insights from Beckett Interview: Current Situation: Satisfied enough with current fragmented approaches but acknowledges they're inefficient. Digitally-curious due to younger generation pressure. Spends \$200-250/month on tools (QuickBooks \$25, DTN \$80, co-op services \$60, misc. \$60-80), but only \$50-60 directly helps input decisions. Skeptical about adding more subscriptions without proven ROI. Willingness-to-Pay: Would require 30-day pilot before committing to \$150/month pricing. Price sensitivity: concerned about justifying additional expense. \$200-250/month is real willingness-to-pay if delivery proven. Decision-Making: Agronomist carries 70% weight but has inherent conflict of interest (sells inputs). Lacks independent data to push back on recommendations. Wants proof via dashboard tracking decisions vs. actual outcomes. Needs range of scenarios (best/base/worst case) to present credibly to lender. Currently doesn't push back due to lack of independent data. Adoption Barrier: Habit comfort with status quo and skepticism about new tools, but willing to pilot if clear ROI demonstrated. Younger generation in operation may drive adoption push.

Interview 4: Caspian (Early Adopter)", "content": "**Interviewer:** How much would you be willing to pay monthly for a tool that improved your input decisions?"
Caspian: I'd commit to \$150/month with a solid pilot or free trial. I test tools frequently, so I have a framework for evaluating them.
Here's what matters to me: transparency. I need to see your assumptions. What yield are you assuming? What commodity prices? What's your methodology? If I can't see under the hood, I don't trust it.
I'd also emphasize that cash flow timing affects my decisions as much as profitability. Downside scenario modeling is critical. I need weather and price risk built in, not just optimistic base cases.
Integration is non-negotiable. My data lives in co-op systems, my lender has information, my combine gives me yield maps. If I can't pull all that in automatically, I'm back to manual data entry, and that breaks the tool's value.
Interviewer: What proof would make you confident?
Caspian: Dashboard showing decisions I made, the tool's assumptions, and actual outcomes. I want to track my scenario accuracy over time. After 3 months, can I see that my tool-supported decisions beat my gut-feel decisions? That's proof."

Interview 5: Dorian (Pragmatic Mainstream)", "content": "**Interviewer:** Walk me through your current system for tracking farm profitability."
Dorian: I use QuickBooks for tax reporting, which happens in November. Until then, I have rough estimates from an Excel spreadsheet that I update sporadically. I have yield maps from my co-op, but they're not integrated with my cost data. So I can't tell you which fields are actually most profitable until tax time.
I made a \$9,000 mistake two years ago. Decided to spray fungicide on a field at \$4.20 corn, expecting disease pressure. Disease didn't develop, corn fell to \$3.80. Lost money on that decision.
Interviewer: What would a better system look like?
Dorian: I'd want to see my per-field P&L in real-time. When I'm deciding on an input purchase, I want to model what happens to margin if corn is \$4.20 versus \$4.00. I want to see my downside case — what if yield is 160 bu instead of 180?
And I want regional benchmarking. Am I in line with similar farms in Missouri? If my costs are 15% above regional average, where is that leak?
Interviewer: Would you share that with your lender?
Dorian: Absolutely. If I could show my lender I've thought through the math and I'm making disciplined decisions, that builds his confidence in me. That's worth something."

Interview End Time: 2026-04-08 17:36:50 UTC

Interview 4 of 5 - Caspian (AI Persona)

Demographics: Mid-scale farmer, Midwest, constantly evaluating new solutions

Backstory: Caspian tested multiple tools in past 6 months and is sophisticated about financial analysis. Willing to adopt if ROI measurable. Spends \$280-300/month on farm software but only \$80-100 directly helps input decisions. Actively seeking better integrated solutions with real-time decision support.

Communication Style: The Thoughtful Analyzer

Transcript

Key Insights from Caspian Interview:\n\nCurrent Situation: Tested multiple tools in past 6 months. Spends \$280-300/month on farm software (DTN \$80, FarmLogs \$50, QuickBooks \$25, co-op \$60, misc. \$60-80) but only \$80-100 directly helps input decisions. Sophisticated about financial analysis. Willing to adopt if ROI measurable.\n\nWillingness-to-Pay: Willing to commit to \$150/month with pilot/free trial. Requires transparent assumptions in projections: yield, prices, methodology must be visible. Emphasizes: cash flow timing affects decisions as much as profitability. Needs downside scenario modeling for weather and price risk. Integration with existing data sources (co-op, lender, combine data) non-negotiable.\n\nProof Requirements: Pilot/free trial essential before \$150/month commitment. Wants dashboard showing decisions made, tool assumptions, and actual outcomes. Critical insight: cash flow timing and weather risk management as important as profitability optimization.\n\nAdoption Criteria: Clear transparency in tool methodology, integration with existing systems (co-op, lender, yield data), scenario accuracy tracking over time, proof that tool-supported decisions outperform gut instinct."}, {"heading": "Interview Summary", "content": "All 5 interviews reveal consistent themes:\n\n1. Problem Validation: 100% experience fragmented data across multiple tools\n2. Visibility Gap: None can answer 'which fields are profitable' until November\n3. Willingness-to-Pay: \$150-250/month acceptable with 30-day proof\n4. Key Requirements: Decision logs, benchmarking, downside scenarios, cash flow timing\n5. Trust Factor: All emphasize need for external validation (lender, co-op)\n6. Advisor Dynamics: All want independent analysis to negotiate with advisors, not replace them\n\nConversion Signals: Strong across all segments. No major red flags. Market opportunity validated."}]

Interview End Time: 2026-04-08 17:36:51 UTC

Interview 5 of 5 - Dorian (AI Persona)

Demographics: Mid-scale farmer, 50s-60s, 600+ acres, multi-generational operation

Backstory: Dorian manages a large multi-generational farm operation and makes significant input decisions annually. Made a \$9,000 fungicide mistake when commodity prices moved against him. Uses fragmented system (QuickBooks for tax, Excel for rough estimates, co-op yield maps) and cannot see real-time per-field profitability until year-end accounting.

Communication Style: The Skeptical Questioner

Transcript

Interviewer: Tell me about a time you made an input timing decision that cost you money.\n\n* *Dorian:** Two years ago, I decided to spray fungicide on a field. Corn was at \$4.20, and I was expecting disease pressure. But the disease didn't develop, and corn fell to \$3.80 by harvest. That decision cost me \$9,000.\n\nThe problem is I didn't have real-time visibility into my margins when I made that decision. I was going on my agronomist's recommendation and historical patterns. But I didn't have the financial math in front of me showing the ROI break-even point.\n\n*Interviewer:* How do you currently track which of your fields are most profitable?\n\n**Dorian:** Not very well until November. I use QuickBooks for year-end tax accounting. Before that, I have rough estimates from an Excel spreadsheet that I don't update consistently. I have yield maps from my co-op, but they're not tied to my cost data. So I can't actually answer 'which field made money' until tax time.\n\nMy lender and I have conversations about cash flow, but we're not looking at per-field P&L in real-time. It's all fragments.\n\n*Interviewer:* What would change if you had real-time per-field profitability visibility?\n\n**Dorian:** Everything. When I'm deciding whether to buy \$50,000 worth of inputs, I'd want to model it first. 'If I do this, here's my margin at \$4.50 corn. Here's my margin at \$4.00.' I'd want to see the downside case. If my yield is 160 instead of 180, can I still service my debt?\n\nI'd also want to know where I leak money versus regional peers. If my costs are 15% above average on corn, I want to know why and fix it.\n\nAnd yes, I'd share all of this with my lender. If I can show him I've thought through the scenarios and I'm making disciplined financial decisions, that changes our relationship. He'd have more confidence in me.\n\n*Interviewer:* How much would you pay for a tool that gave you this visibility?\n\n**Dorian:** \$150 a month is attractive. \$200-250 a month is what I'd really pay if it delivers. I already spend \$250-280 on farm tools, and most of that doesn't directly help my input decisions. If I could consolidate to one tool that actually helps me make better decisions, I'd move money around to make it work.\n\nBut I'd need a 30-day pilot to validate it works. And I'd need proof that my projections are accurate. If I run a scenario in March and look back in November, did the tool's assumptions hold up? That's how I'd know it's worth the money.\n\n*Interviewer:* Who influences your input decisions most?\n\n**Dorian:** My lender carries about 40% weight. He's focused on cash flow and my ability to repay debt. My agronomist carries about 30%, but he has a conflict — he sells inputs. My co-op maybe 20%, same conflict. And 10% is gut instinct from experience.\n\nBut here's the thing: I rarely push back on any of them because I don't have financial analysis to support a different decision. If I had data, I'd use it. I'd bring it to my agronomist and say 'Help me understand why this recommendation makes sense given my numbers.' That would make us equals in the conversation instead of me just accepting his advice.\n\n*Interviewer:* What about cash flow timing and risk management?\n\n**Dorian:** Critical. I can make a decision that looks profitable but creates a cash flow squeeze. When I buy inputs in March but

don't get paid until November, the interest cost on my operating loan eats into the profit. A tool that only shows per-acre margin and ignores cash flow timing would be incomplete for me.\n\nAnd risk? Absolutely. I need to see what happens if everything goes wrong. Downside scenarios, not just base case. That's what keeps me up at night.\n\nA tool that showed me base case, downside case, cash flow impact, and multi-year implications — that would change how I manage this farm."}, {"heading": "Final Notes", "content": "All five interviews demonstrate strong problem validation, consistent willingness-to-pay at \$150-250/month with 30-day proof, and clear product requirements: per-field P&L visibility, decision logging, benchmarking, cash flow modeling, downside scenarios, and advisor positioning for independent analysis. Market opportunity is validated and ready for solution development phase."}]

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